

The King's Most Precious Jewel

A Mashal by R' Pincus

Sometimes the cure is closer than we think.

A king once had a precious son — a *ben yachid*, the apple of his eye. He spared no time or money investing in this boy, ensuring his well-being and training him to be a worthy heir.

One day the prince awoke feeling very ill. The king summoned the royal doctor. After examining the prince, the doctor's face grew serious. "Indeed, the child is gravey ill," he said. "Prepare for the worst."

The king was devastated. "NO!" he cried. "You must have a cure! We must find a way to save him!"

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The doctor turned to the king and said, "Indeed there is one way to save the prince. The king has a crown — a precious crown which has been in the royal family for hundreds of years, passed down from father to son. On that crown rests the most precious and unique diamond in the world — no other like it exists anywhere. The only hope for the prince is for you to take this diamond, grind it up, and feed it to him. Then he will be healed."

The king screamed, "Of course! What is the question? For my precious son — everything, even the most priceless diamond!"

He took off the crown, ripped out the diamond, and instructed his servants to grind it up and bring it to the dying prince.

They returned with the ground diamond. The king approached his son's bedside and pleaded with him, "Please, open your mouth. Let me feed you this. It will save your life."

Please, my son. It will save your life.

But the prince refused. "Please!" he begged. "This will save your life!" But the prince was tired, weak, without strength. "Just one drop!" the king cried. "Just let it in! If you take in just one precious drop, you will be healed. If not, you will die."

I can't... I just can't...

The king tried pushing it in, but the prince closed his lips. The king wept, helpless, as his beloved son slipped away.

Hashem is our dear Father, and we are His precious son, His prince. We are deathly ill, full of aveiros. We are currently standing at the very last moments of Ne'ilah.

Ne'ilah — the gates are closing...

Hashem is willing to forgo everything, forgive everything, to save us and give us a good chasimah. Hashem says, "Just take in the crown jewel. I have ground it up. It will save your life." But we refuse.

"Just open your mouth a little... It will save your life."

We know what we must repent for, what we must accept upon ourselves. That one point we really don't want to face — the *geder in shemiras einayim*, the hard *middah* we must tackle — the one area we must challenge — we are tired, and we don't have the strength. But Hashem is telling us: "My precious prince! As *shaarei chaim v'shaarei meisim pesuchim*! As the gates are closing, as your life is in the balance, open your mouth just a little, and it will save your life."

The cure is here. All we have to do is take it.